

Sony to target mobile games

Sony is gearing up to launch at least five mobile games by 2018 based on popular PlayStation game franchises. <http://dgit.in/SnyMG18>



Nike+ Watch launched

Apple Watch Nike+ is a unique version of the Apple Watch Series 2 with Nike Watch faces for \$369 and \$399. <http://dgit.in/AplNikePls>

Origins

The origin and history of Social media

Until about two decades ago, the world was not as connected as it is today. In this month's Origins, we trace the roots of the social media as it stands today.

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Social media is a field spread out wide across the Internet, encompassing vast legions from across the world pouring our heads and hearts out to anyone who would care to listen. There have been innumerable arguments about it: the impact it has had on our society, the way it has been setting mental construct, and how it has contributed to our growing dependence on technology and a need for approval of what we think and do. Numerous research and statistics have pointed to social media having an unthinkable impact on everything, be it for the positive or negative.

The world of social media opened a completely different field of analysis in itself. We now analyse trends, observe behaviour and connect the dots to conclude on how large sections of populations are feeling, what nations are talking about, and more. Publications and industries alike nowadays consider social media with prime importance to ensure they reach out to the widest possible audience. Publications are

increasingly shifting to an online-first model, and social media plays a crucial role in retaining their readership.

Here, we try to trace the roots of where it all began, how it took the eventual course of evolution, and everything that influenced the rise of social media from chat windows with tacky backgrounds to the thriving, connected world that it is today.



CompuServe

The one that started it all

The Rise

Rather than fixing a year or a web portal as the point of origin, the formation of World Wide Web and the subsequent increase in instantaneous connectivity of the Internet is regarded as the starting point of social media. The rise of Internet gave the world the power of near-instant communication, which would eventually open up a world of possibilities, and the landscape of social media.

The earliest social media can be traced back to the 1970s, with the likes

of CompuServe and Bulletin Board System. Back in the '70s and '80s, CompuServe presented for the very first time something that the world had never really experienced before – instantaneous communication with friends residing miles away. Admittedly, connectivity was scarce and the technology was limiting, but for the limited few privy to CompuServe, it was fascinating. Individuals on CompuServe could only exchange text messages, which were not unlike emails. Like something that had never happened before, messages could now be received and replied to within minutes, although the data transmission speeds back then were incredibly low.

CompuServe was also the very first instance of online forums – a place where people got to meet hundreds of others, and discuss events and incidents in real time. This was the first real instance of social media – a medium for individuals to present a digital avatar of themselves and express their own opinions on varying subjects. CompuServe's forums proved immensely popular, exhibiting to the world the possibility that worldwide connectivity had.

About a few years later, BBS (or Bulletin Board System) presented what can be termed as the Internet's first file transfer system. BBS units were mostly based on local networks and hosted by hobbyists looking to experiment with technology and the Internet. Individuals could log on